

Missoula's next 43,000 homes are already on the books

The adopted Growth Policy makes room to nearly double the city's housing stock on vacant and underbuilt land — enough to deliver the 2045 Land Use Plan's 22,000–27,500-home target 1.6–2× over, netting out floodway and steep-slope acres.

Moderate cluster (90% confidence) Strong cluster (95% confidence)
Very strong cluster (99% confidence) No significant clustering



≈43,000

plan-enabled homes on 3,419 vacant and underbuilt parcels — no plan change needed

54%

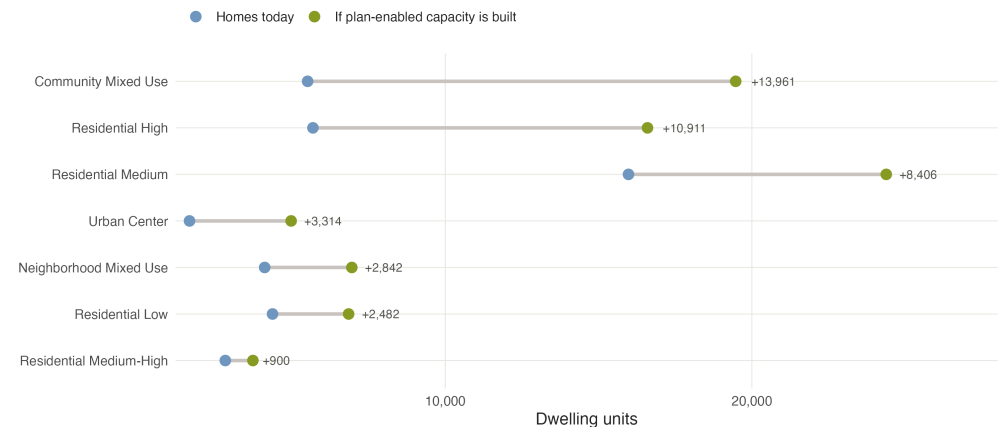
of capacity is infill on parcels ≤ 5 acres — unlocked by code, not land assembly

58%

of this capacity is within a ¼-mile walk of a Mountain Line bus stop

The Growth Policy already makes room for ~43,000 more homes

Dwelling units by Growth Policy future land-use designation (not current zoning): today vs. with capacity on vacant and underbuilt parcels



Plan-enabled capacity = allowable density x developable acres on unconstrained soft parcels, net of existing units. Densities: midpoints of the adopted 2035 Growth Policy designation ranges.

What this means for the code reform

1. Align zoning with the plan in the hot-spot clusters (North Reserve, Linda Vista/Miller Creek, South Hills) — that's where entitlement friction costs the most homes.
2. Make small infill by-right: half the capacity sits on parcels a small builder can develop under simple rules.
3. Pair upzoning with mobile-home park preservation before surrounding land values move.

The affordability stakes: Missoula is 52% renter, and half of renters are cost-burdened (ACS 2019–23). ≈2,600 of the city's lowest-cost (NOAH) homes sit in or beside the growth clusters; separately, 530 mobile-home parcels (≈2,850 units) sit on planned-density land citywide. All are excluded from the count above — preservation must move with upzoning.